

Interview Preparation Sheet: David Burnley

Interviewee Profile

Name	David Burnley
Current Title	Vice President, Product Innovation
Company	Insperity
Tenure	Joined February 2018
Location	Houston, Texas Area

Company Overview: Insperity

- **Business Focus:** Insperity provides scalable HR solutions, functioning primarily as a Professional Employer Organization (PEO) for small and mid-sized businesses. They assist businesses in managing payroll, benefits, compliance, and other complex HR tasks.
- **Scale & Impact:** Insperity supports more than 300,000 worksite employees across the United States. As of 2022, they generated roughly \$5.9 billion in revenue and operate in more than 90 locations nationwide.
- **Recent Modernization & AI Push:** Insperity is undergoing a major internal digital transformation. To prepare for an "AI-first future," they recently migrated over 33 million HR records to a modernized enterprise content strategy using Box AI. This enables AI-powered metadata extraction, enhancing data security, compliance, and automated retention policies.
- **Product Expansion:** Insperity continuously expands its product portfolio to meet evolving workforce demands. They recently launched *Insperity Contractor Management powered by Wingspan* to address the significant increase in 1099 independent contractors.

Key Themes & Executive Insights

Based on recent industry panels and publications, David Burnley's professional focus centers around pragmatic enterprise AI adoption and optimizing workforce technology for remote environments.

1. Enterprise AI: "Buy vs. Build" Strategies

In a panel discussion on AI in the enterprise alongside other industry leaders, David shared his strategic approach to implementing AI capabilities:

- **Pragmatic Implementation:** David has successfully navigated both *buying* and *building* AI products during his tenure at Insperity.
- **Strategic Decision-Making:** He advises that an enterprise company's capacity to build or buy is heavily dependent on the internal talent and operational structures already in place. Organizations with a robust team of engineers and domain experts are more likely and better equipped to build custom, superior solutions rather than purchasing off-the-shelf software.

2. Remote Work Infrastructure & Preventing Burnout

During an Inc. 5000 Vision Conference panel, David discussed the realities of remote work transitions and the technology required to support employees sustainably:

- **Employee Enablement:** David stressed that successful remote models require companies to actively assist employees with their home infrastructure. For Insperity, this involved deploying specific programs to ensure employees had sufficient bandwidth and reliable connections to remain productive at home.
- **Addressing the Disillusionment Phase:** He highlighted the psychological shift during remote work transitions—moving from a "get through it" adrenaline phase to reality setting in. He emphasizes the importance of utilizing standard communication and video tools to reduce friction, foster connection, and mitigate the severe risk of employee burnout.

Strategic Interview Questions to Ask David

Use these questions to drive a deep, strategic conversation regarding product innovation, AI integration, and HR technology trends.

1. **On AI and "Buy vs. Build":** *"In previous discussions, you've mentioned that Insperity's approach to buying versus building AI products is heavily determined by your existing talent and operations. As the VP of Product Innovation, how do you currently evaluate the threshold for when to build a proprietary AI tool versus partnering with an established vendor like Box?"*
2. **On the Future of HR Tech:** *"Insperity manages millions of sensitive HR records and is actively moving toward an 'AI-first future' with initiatives like Box AI metadata extraction. What do you see as the next frontier for HR technology over the next 3 to 5 years, particularly when it comes to the employee experience?"*
3. **On Workforce Evolution:** *"With the launch of Insperity Contractor Management, it's clear the company is adapting to the gig economy and a 1099 workforce. How does this structural shift in workforce dynamics change your product roadmap and innovation strategy?"*
4. **On Innovation Culture:** *"You've been leading Product Innovation at Insperity since 2018. Over the last several years—navigating immediate remote work shifts and now the AI boom—how have you evolved your team's culture to keep them agile and forward-thinking?"*

Interview Preparation Strategy & Best Practices

- **Emphasize Security and Scale:** As a PEO, Insperity's products must be rock-solid regarding compliance and data privacy. When discussing innovation, acknowledge the necessary balance between moving fast with new technologies (like Generative AI) and maintaining absolute security over highly sensitive HR data.
- **Focus on the Human Element:** Insperity's core motto is "HR that Makes a Difference." David has publicly emphasized employee well-being, such as taking active steps to avoid remote work burnout. Frame your conversational points around how technology and product innovation serve to enhance the *human* experience, rather than just driving administrative efficiency.
- **Acknowledge Macro-Trends:** Be prepared to confidently discuss broader macro-economic and employment trends, such as the rise of the independent contractor, the complexities of hybrid work environments, and the practical application of machine learning in enterprise settings.